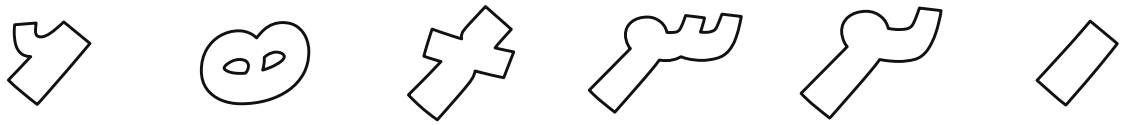
ALLAMAHUL BAYAN SERIES · BOOK 17

عَلَّمَهُ الْبَيَانَ

# My First Dhivehi Alphabet

# ދިވެހި ފުރަތަމަ ބާވަރު ދަސްކުރާ

A Coloring Book to Learn, Trace & Say the 24 Dhivehi Letters with English Phonetics



**Written by Hafez Abdullah Muhammad Minhaz Reza**

Illustrations: AI-assisted, edited by the author

**Maktabatu Kunujul Akhirah**

مكتبة كنوز الآخرة

**REVIEW DRAFT — not for publication**

**REVIEW DRAFT — DO NOT PUBLISH YET.** The letter names, sound guides, words, transliterations and phrases in this book were drafted with AI and have not yet been checked by a native speaker. After review, set `draft=False` in the language file and rebuild; this notice then disappears.

**My First Dhivehi Alphabet** — ދިވެހި ފުރަތަމަ ބާކުރާ ގަނޑު

Allamahul Bayan Series, Book 17

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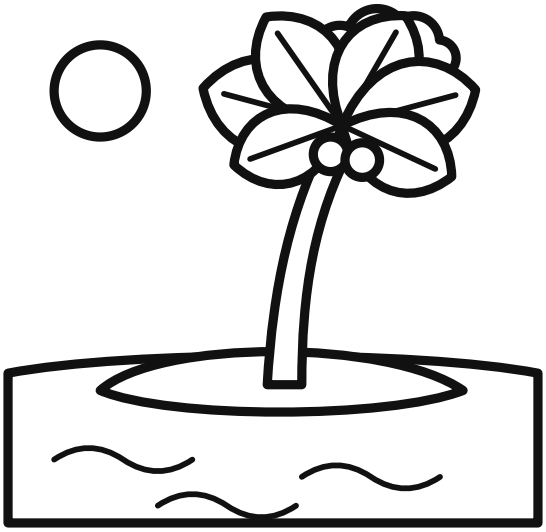
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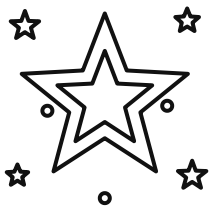
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**Map data:** Natural Earth (public domain).

**A note of respect:** this book contains verses of the Noble Qur'an (pages 4–5). Please handle it with care and keep it in a clean place.

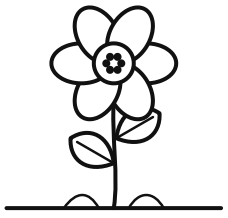


# This book belongs to
## ދ ފުރުވި ތަނަވަސްދަ ފުރުމަ

I started learning Dhivehi on







ABOUT THIS SERIES

# The Allamahul Bayan Series

عَلَّمَهُ الْبَيَانَ

*ʿallamahul-bayān — "He taught him clear expression"*

الرَّحْمَٰنُ ﴿١﴾ عَلَّمَ الْقُرْآنَ ﴿٢﴾ خَلَقَ الْإِنسَانَ ﴿٣﴾ عَلَّمَهُ الْبَيَانَ ﴿٤﴾

*Ar-Raḥmān. ʿAllamal-Qurʾān. Khalaqal-insān. ʿAllamahul-bayān.*

"The Most Merciful. He taught the Qur'an. He created the human being. He taught him clear expression (al-bayān)."

**Surah Ar-Raḥmān 55:1–4**[1]

Surah Ar-Raḥmān — the chapter of *The Most Merciful* — opens by naming some of Allah's greatest gifts to us. First, **He taught the Qur'an**. Then, **He created the human being**. And then, **He taught him al-bayān**.

**What does *al-bayān* mean?** It comes from an Arabic root that means *to make something clear*. Al-bayān is the gift of speech and understanding: being able to put what is in our hearts and minds into words, to explain, to listen, and to be understood. Animals make sounds, but only people were taught to speak, read and write in languages. Scholars of tafsīr explain that this gift is what lets us learn, teach and pass on guidance — including the Qur'an itself.

So every time a child says a new word, sounds out a letter, or writes their first line in a new language, they are using a gift that Allah Himself says He taught. That is the heart of this series: **learning languages as a way of thanking Allah for al-bayān.**

# Languages and colours: two signs of Allah

وَمِنْ آيَاتِهِ خَلْقُ السَّمَاوَاتِ وَالْأَرْضِ وَاخْتِلَافُ أَلْسِنَتِكُمْ وَأَلْوَانِكُمْ ۚ إِنَّ فِي ذَٰلِكَ لَآيَاتٍ لِّلْعَالِمِينَ ﴿٢٢﴾

*Wa min āyātihī khalqus-samāwāti wal-arḍi wakh-tilāfu alsinatikum wa alwānikum. Inna fī dhālika la-āyātil-lil-ʿālimīn.*

"And among His signs is the creation of the heavens and the earth, and the variety of your languages and your colours. Surely in that are signs for those who know."

**Surah Ar-Rūm 30:22**[1]

In Surah Ar-Rūm, Allah tells us that the **many languages** of people and their **many colours** are among His signs. A coloring book that teaches a language brings both of these signs together in a child's hands: they meet a new language, and they fill its letters with colour.

وَجَعَلْنَاكُمْ شُعُوبًا وَقَبَائِلَ لِتَعَارَفُوا

*Wa jaʿalnākum shuʿūban wa qabāʾila li-taʿārafū.*

"...and We made you into peoples and tribes so that you may get to know one another."

**Surah Al-Ḥujurāt 49:13 (part)**[1]

Allah made us into many peoples *so that we may get to know one another*. Learning even a few letters of someone's language is a beautiful first step towards knowing them.

### How each book in the series works

Every book introduces one language **through English**:

- where the language is spoken, with a map to color;
- every letter of its alphabet, with its name in the language itself *and* in English letters;
- simple English sound guides, so a parent who has never heard the language can still help;
- a word and picture for every letter, to color, trace and say out loud.

**Book 17 is Dhivehi**. More languages from around the world are in the series, in shā' Allāh.

FOR PARENTS AND TEACHERS

# How to use this book

Begin with **Bismillah**, and go **little and often**: one letter a day is plenty for a young child. For each letter:

1. **Say it.** Read the letter's name and its sound guide together. Say it three times.
2. **Color it.** Color the big letter any way your child likes.
3. **Trace it.** Trace the dotted letters with a pencil, then try one alone in the empty boxes.
4. **Meet the word.** Say the word, color the picture, and talk about it in English.

**Marker tip:** every coloring page has a blank back, so colours cannot spoil the next activity. Slip a sheet of scrap paper behind the page you are coloring anyway — it keeps the next page clean.

### Reading the English sound guides

- **Dhivehi is read from right to left**, like the Qur'an. The tracing rows on each page also start on the right.
- **Doubled vowels are long:** *aa* as in "father", *ee* as in "see", *oo* as in "moon". Maldivians write long e and o as **ey** and **oa**: *vaarey* (rain), *dhoani* (boat).
- **dh** and **th** are a soft *d* and *t* with the tongue on the back of the teeth — never the English "th" of "the". Plain **d** and **t** are hard: curl the tongue back.
- **lh** is an *l* said with the tongue curled back: *valhu* (well).
- **nd, nb, ndh** in words like *handhu* (moon) and *anbu* (mango): say the *n* very lightly, gliding into the next sound.

### Three ways to see every sound

Each letter page shows the sound three ways: the letter's **Dhivehi name** written in Dhivehi (native phonetics), the **same name in English letters**, and an **English sound guide**. In Thaana the vowels are small signs called **fili**. The box marked *the letter with its fili* shows the letter wearing each of the ten fili, with the sound underneath: ◌ *ha*, ◌ *haa*, ◌ *hi*…

The pronunciation guides are simplified for young learners and follow the standard Dhivehi of Malé.

MEET THE LANGUAGE

# Hello, Dhivehi! ދިވެހި

*dhivehi — the Dhivehi word for the language*

**Who speaks it?**
About **340,000 people** speak Dhivehi, almost all of them in the Maldives.[3]

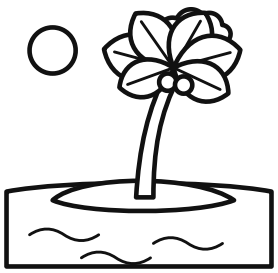
**Where?**
In the **Maldives**: about **1,200 small coral islands** in the Indian Ocean, in rings called **atolls**. The Maldives is a Muslim country, and island after island has its own mosque.

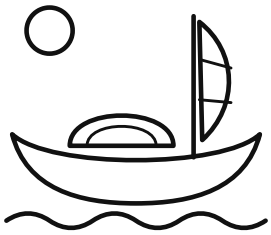
**How is it written?**
In **Thaana**, from **right to left**. The vowels are little strokes called **fili**, written above or below each letter.

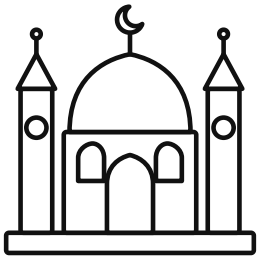
**How many letters?**
**24** basic letters, plus dotted letters for Arabic words: ﷺ ﷻ ﷼ ﷽ ﷾ ﷿ ﷸ ﷹ ﷷ ﷵ ﷶ

**Letters from numbers!**
The first nine letters, ހ to ވ, were made from the Arabic numerals 1–9, and the next nine from old Dhivehi numerals.

**Letters on the map**
The atolls have letter names in alphabet order, from north to south: Haa Alifu, Shaviyani, Noonu, Raa, Baa… all the way down to Seenu.







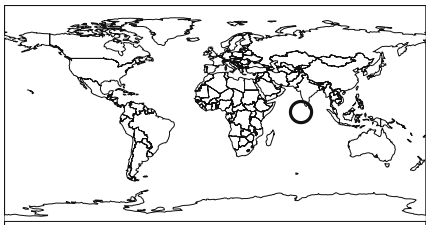
THE WHOLE ALPHABET

# The Dhivehi Alphabet ދިވެހި

## 24 letters — ދިވެހި ތަނބުރު

| | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| ލ *lhaviyani* | ބ *baa* | ރ *raa* | ނ *noonu* | ޝ *shaviyani* | ހ *haa* |
| ދ *dhaalu* | ފ *faafu* | މ *meemu* | ވ *vaavu* | އ *alifu* | ކ *kaafu* |
| ގ *daviyani* | ސ *seenu* | ހ *gnaviyani* | ގ *gaafu* | ލ *laamu* | ތ *thaa* |
| ཆ *chaviyani* | ཇ *javiyani* | པ *paviyani* | ཡ *yaa* | ཏ *taviyani* | ཟ *zaviyani* |

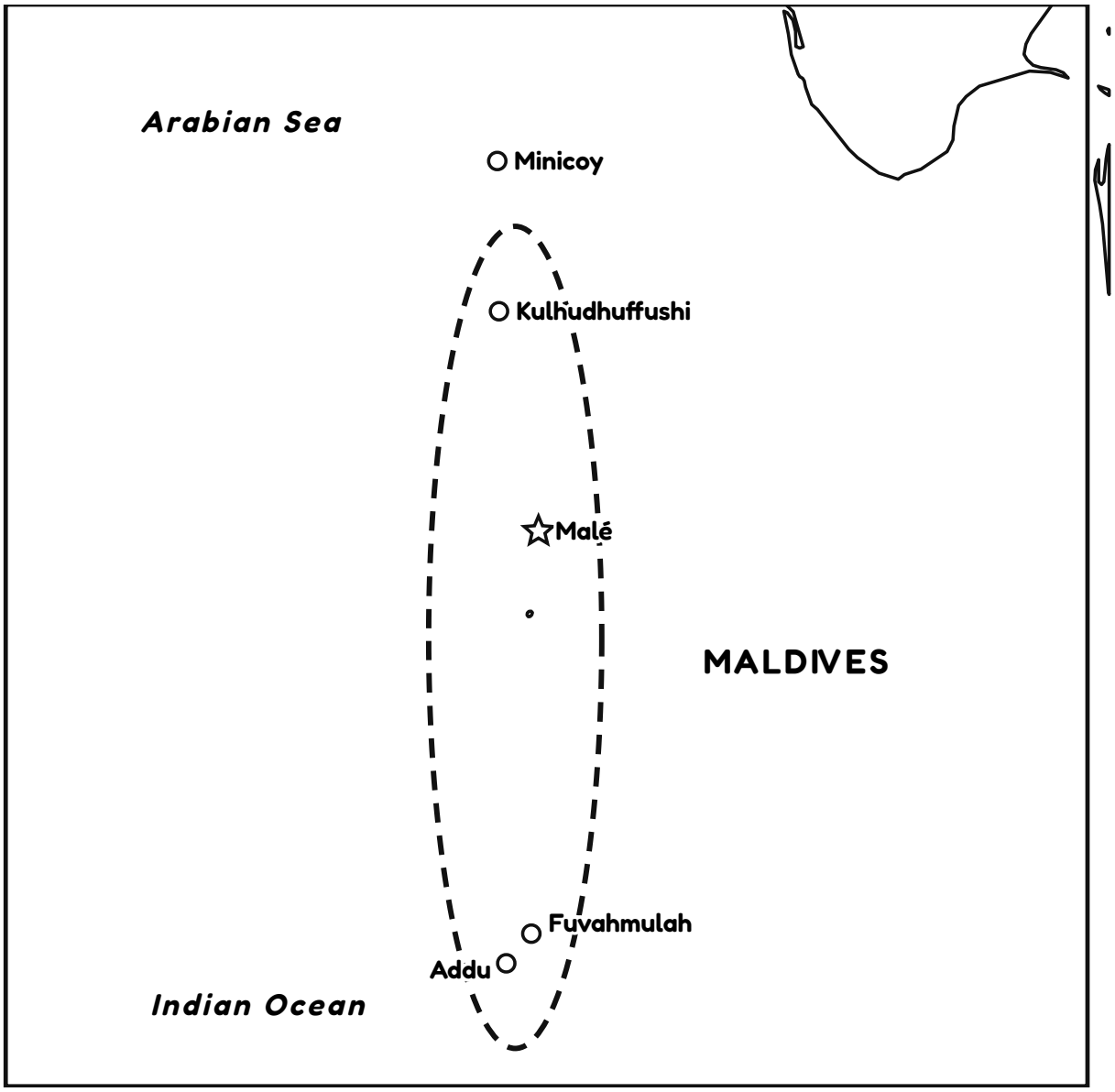
Read the alphabet from **right to left**, row by row — the same order as in this book.



The circle shows the Maldives on the world map.

COLOR THE MAP

# Where is Dhivehi spoken?




**Color it:** the sea **blue** · the land **green**. **Find it:** the Maldives are about 1,200 tiny islands inside the dashed line — most are too small to see on a map! Malé ★ is the capital. Draw little yellow islands along the chain. Dhivehi is also spoken on Minicoy island, to the north.

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THE LETTERS

# The Thaana Letters ތާނަ ހަބަރު

*thaana akuru — “the Thaana letters”*

Dhivehi is written **from right to left**, like the Qur’an. Thaana has **24 basic letters**, and every one of them is a consonant. The vowels are small strokes called **fili** (ފިލި).

**Every letter wears a fili**

In a word, each letter carries a fili **above** or **below** it — or the little circle **sukun**, which means “no vowel”. In this book the big letters are shown bare so you can color them, and each letter page shows the letter with all ten fili.

بِسْ = سْ + بِ  *bi + s = bis* (egg)

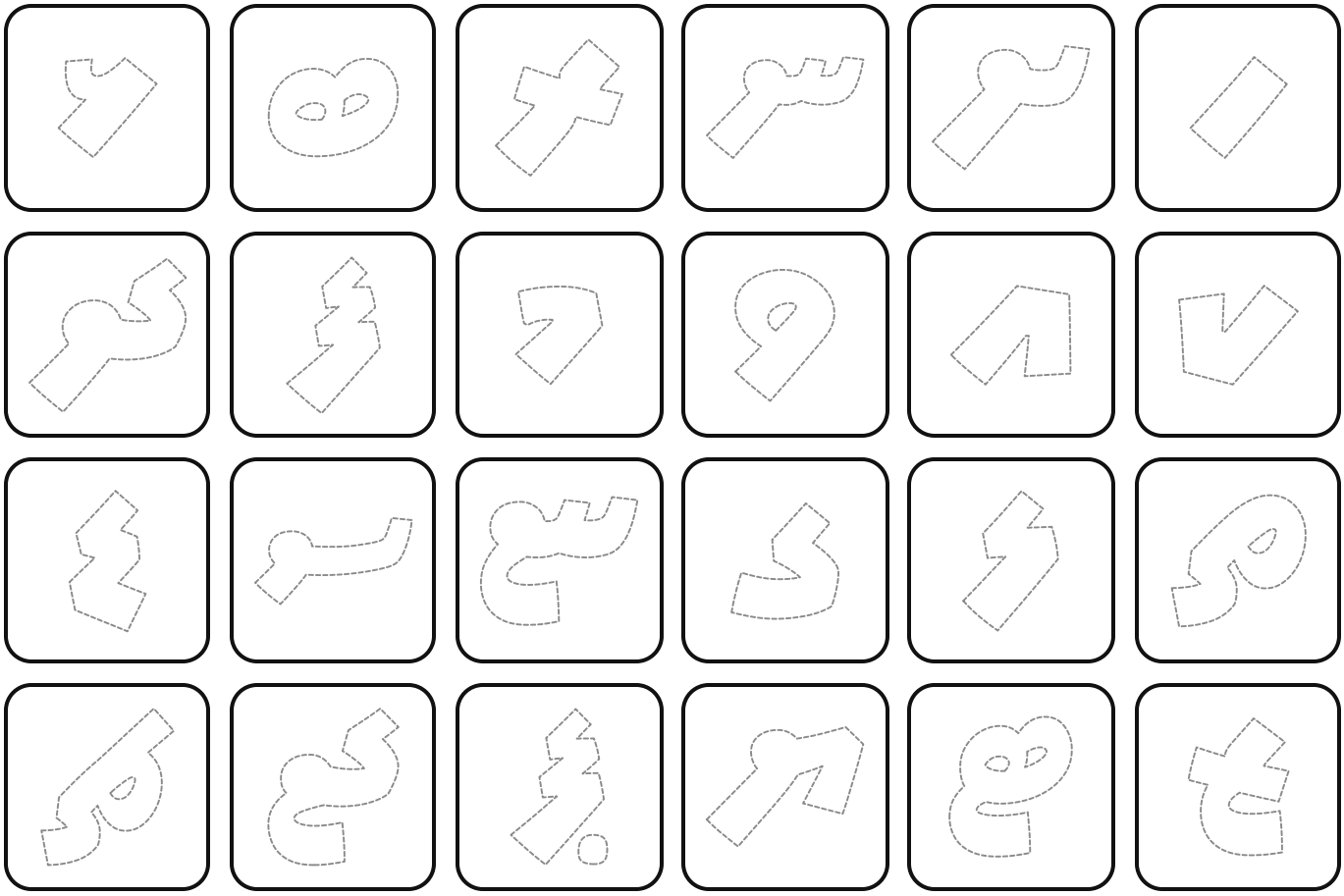
| Fili name | Sound | With ބ | | | Start of a word |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| ﬠ abafili | ‘a’ in “about” | ﬠ | *ba* | ﬡ | *a* |
| ﬠ aabaafili | ‘a’ in “father” | ﬠ | *baa* | ﬡ | *aa* |
| ﬠ ibifili | ‘i’ in “sit” | ﬠ | *bi* | ﬡ | *i* |
| ﬠ eebeefili | ‘ee’ in “see” | ﬠ | *bee* | ﬡ | *ee* |
| ﬠ ubufili | ‘u’ in “put” | ﬠ | *bu* | ﬡ | *u* |
| ﬠ ooboofili | ‘oo’ in “moon” | ﬠ | *boo* | ﬡ | *oo* |
| ﬠ ebefili | ‘e’ in “bed” | ﬠ | *be* | ﬡ | *e* |
| ﬠ eybeyfili | ‘ey’ in “they” | ﬠ | *bey* | ﬡ | *ey* |
| ﬠ obofili | ‘o’ in “on” | ﬠ | *bo* | ﬡ | *o* |
| ﬠ oaboafili | ‘o’ in “go”, long | ﬠ | *boa* | ﬡ | *oa* |
| ﬠ sukun | no vowel | ﬠ | *b* | ﬡ | doubles the next letter |

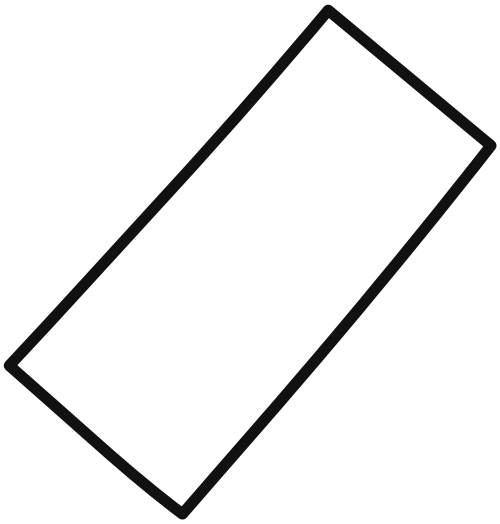
A vowel at the start of a word sits on ﬡ *alifu*, which has no sound of its own: ﬡ ﬢ ﬣ *anbu* (mango).

PENCIL WARM-UP

# Trace the letters ڤۆسۆ ھەبۇغ

Use a **pencil**. Say each letter's name as you trace it.





**NAME · ނަންމަ**

ހ

*haa*

**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

‘h’ as in “hat”

**LETTER + FILI (VOWEL SIGNS)**

| | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| ހ ُ | ހ ِ | ހ ِ | ހ ָ | ހ ַ |
| hu | hee | hi | haa | ha |
| ހ ُ | ހ ֹ | ހ ֶ | ހ ֵ | ހ ֳ |
| hoa | ho | hey | he | hoo |



**ހ IS FOR**

# ހުނަރު

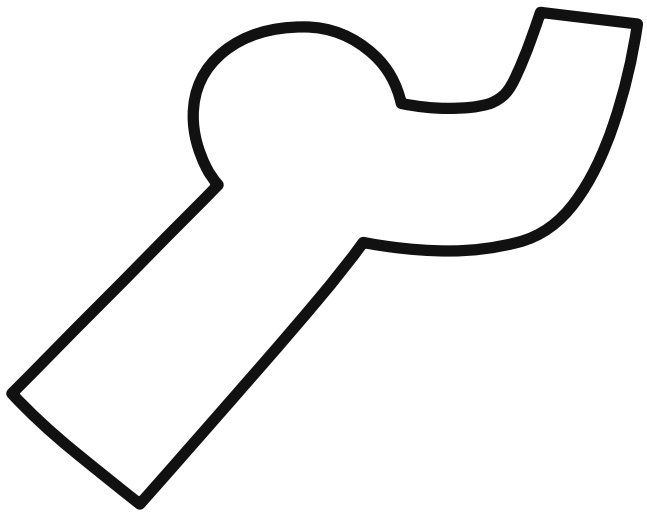
*handhu*

**the moon**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ލިޔުއްވާ**

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**NAME · ނަން**

# ށަވިޔަނި

*shaviyani*

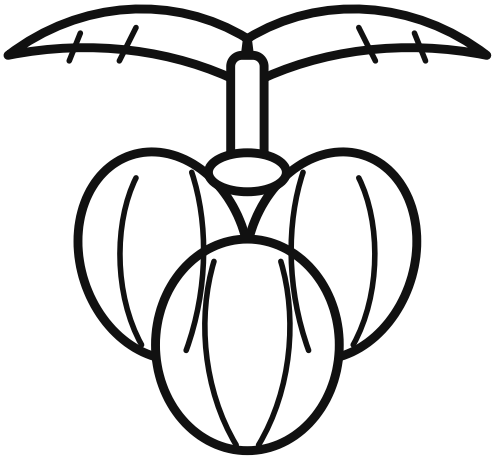
**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

‘sh’ as in “shoe” — but at the end of a word (ްށ) it says ‘h’

**LETTER + FILI (VOWEL SIGNS)**

| | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| ށ | ށ | ށ | ށ | ށ |
| shu | shee | shi | shaa | sha |
| ށ | ށ | ށ | ށ | ށ |
| shoa | sho | shey | she | shoo |

Find ށ inside ށާ — it hardly ever starts a word.



**ށ IS FOR**

# ށާ

*kaashi*

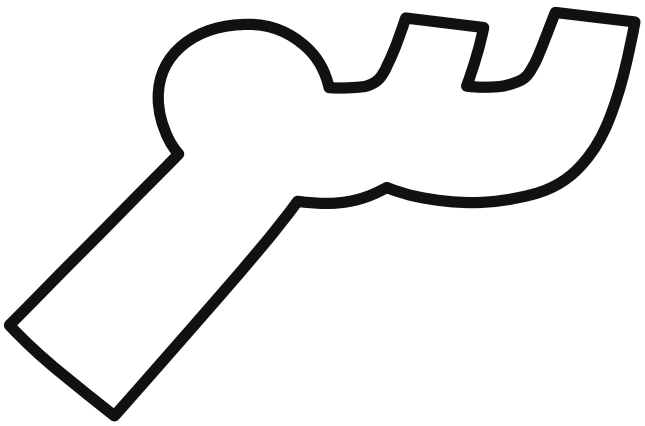
**coconut**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ފުރާ**

ށ ށ ށ ށ

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**NAME · ނޫނު**

# ނޫނު

*noonu*

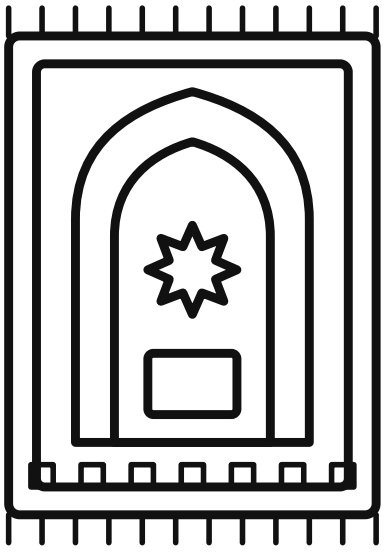
**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

'n' as in "net"

**LETTER + FILI (VOWEL SIGNS)**

| | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| ނު | ނޭ | ނި | ނާ | ނަ |
| nu | nee | ni | naa | na |
| ނ | ނ | ނ | ނ | ނ |
| noa | no | ney | ne | noo |

With no fili, ނ glides into the next letter: *ހަނ*ދުނ *handhu*, *ހ*ަނ*ދ*ު *anbu*.



**ނ IS FOR**

# ނަމާދު

*namaadhu*

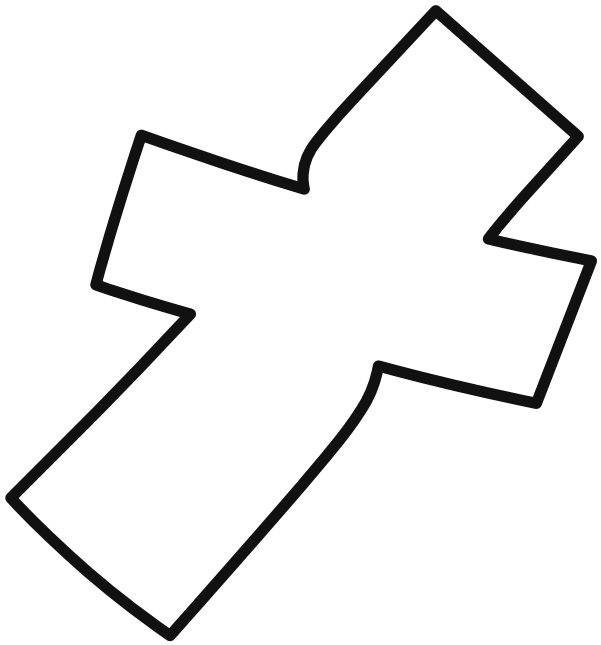
**prayer (salah)**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ؤ ތ ڑ ؤ**

ނ ނ ނ ނ

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**NAME · ނަރުނާ**

ށ

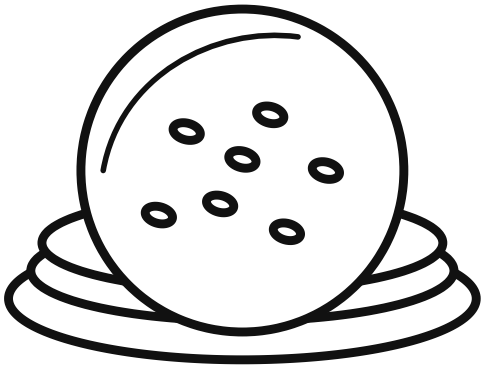
*raa*

**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

a tapped ‘r’ — flick the tongue once

**LETTER + FILI (VOWEL SIGNS)**

| | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| ށ ُ ru | ށ ٔ ree | ށ ِ ri | ށ ٓ raa | ށ ַ ra |
| ށ ۦ roa | ށ ۥ ro | ށ ۧ rey | ށ ۦ re | ށ ۥ roo |



**ށ IS FOR**

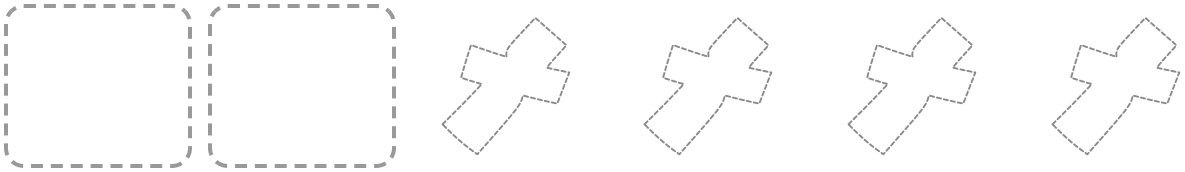


*roshi*

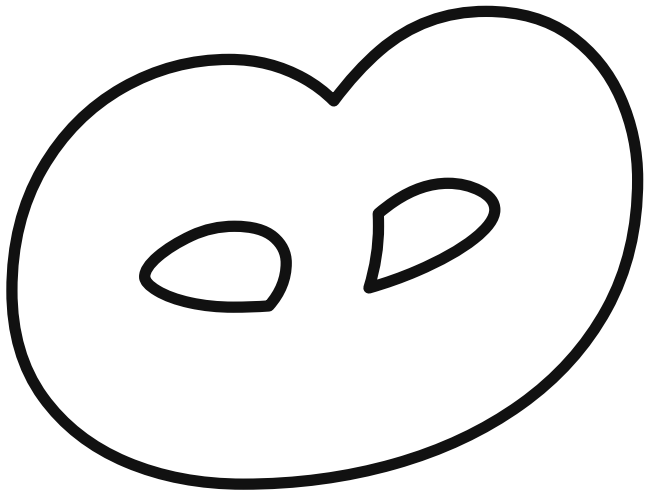
## flatbread (roshi)

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ވަކިވާ**



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**NAME · ނަންސް**

ބ

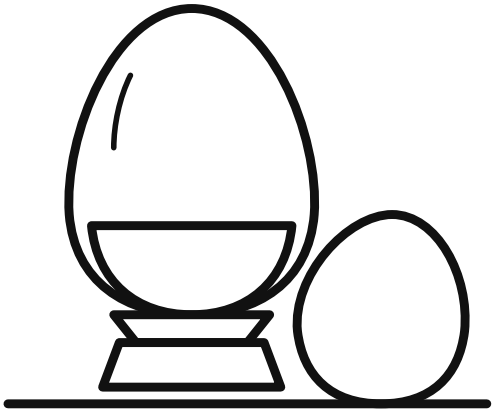
*baa*

**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

‘b’ as in “ball”

**LETTER + FILI (VOWEL SIGNS)**

| | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| ބ ُ | ބ ٓ | ބ ِ | ބ ّ | ބ َ |
| bu | bee | bi | baa | ba |
| ބ ٗ | ބ ٞ | ބ ٔ | ބ ٙ | ބ ٚ |
| boa | bo | bey | be | boo |



**ބ IS FOR**

**ބ ِ ހ ް ނ ު**

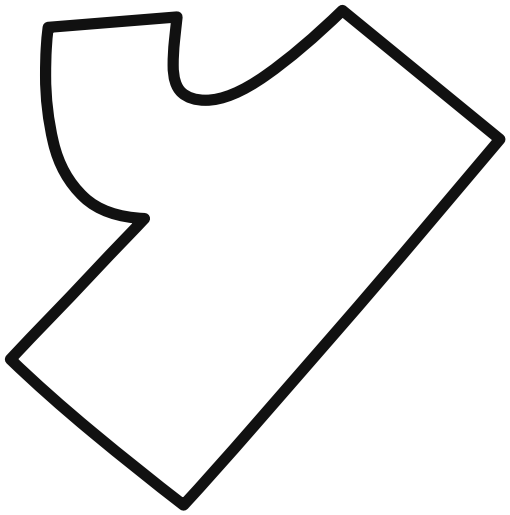
*bis*

**egg**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ؤ ތ ر ؤ ً**

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**NAME · ނަން**

# ލަވިޔަނި

*lhaviyani*

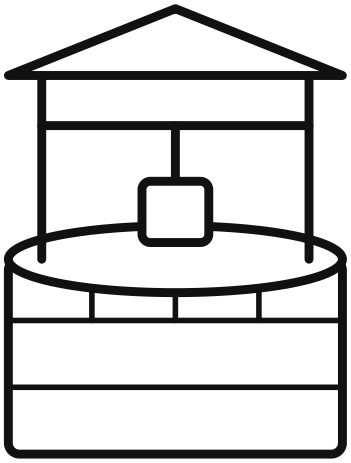
**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

an ‘l’ with the tongue curled back — written ‘lh’

**LETTER + FILI (VOWEL SIGNS)**

| | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| ލ ް | ލ ެ | ލ ި | ލ ާ | ލ |
| lhu | lhee | lhi | lhaa | lha |
| ލ ޮ | ލ ޭ | ލ ެ ް | ލ ޯ | ލ ް |
| lhoa | lho | lhey | lhe | lhoo |

Find ލ inside ވ ް ލ — it hardly ever starts a word.



**ލ IS FOR**

# ވ ް ލ

*valhu*

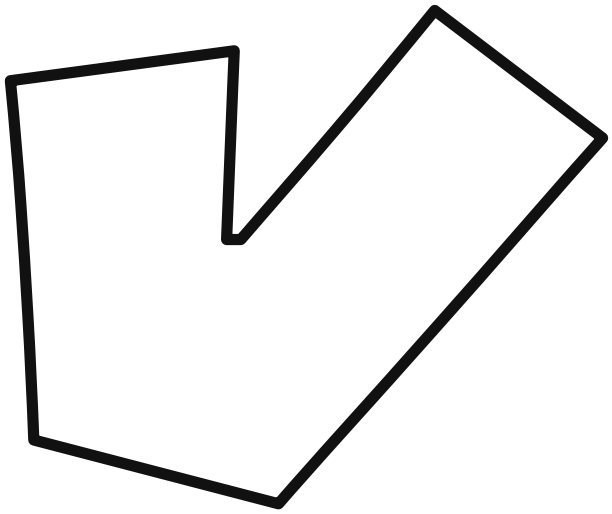
**well (for water)**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ވ ް ލ ު**

ލ ލ ލ ލ

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**NAME · ނަން**

ކ

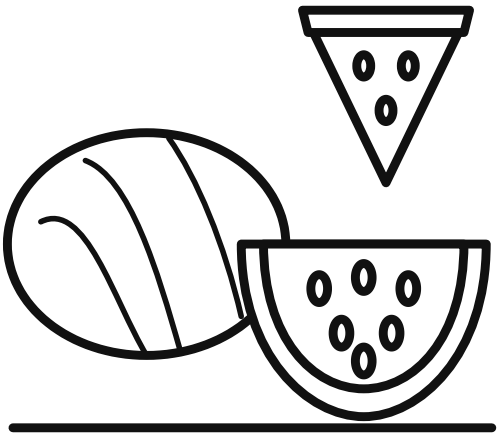
*kaafu*

**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

‘k’ as in “kite”

**LETTER + FILI (VOWEL SIGNS)**

| | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| ކ ु | ku | ކ ी | kee | ki |
| ک | kaa | ک ́ | ka | |
| ک ॅ | koa | ک ॆ | ko | |
| ک े | key | ک ै | ke | |
| ک ॊ | koo | | | |



**ک IS FOR**

ک ́

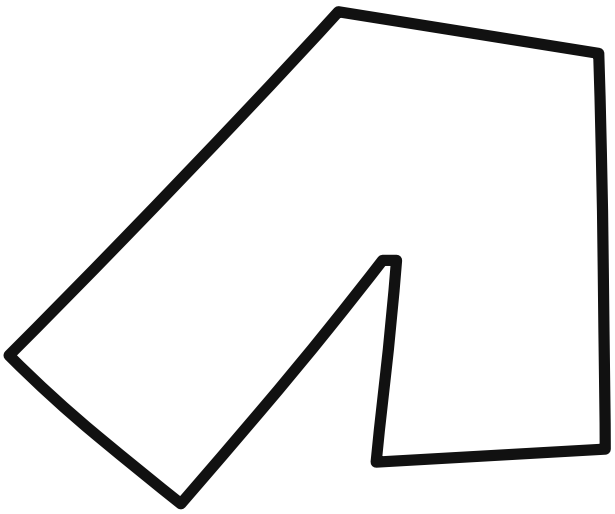
*karaa*

**watermelon**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ލިޔާ**

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**NAME · ނަން**

# ތ ައ ލ ިފ ު

*alifu*

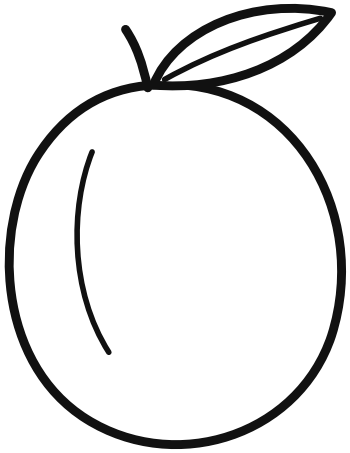
**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

no sound of its own — it carries the vowel at the start of a word

**LETTER + FILI (VOWEL SIGNS)**

| | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| ތ ައ ލ ް | ތ ައ ލ ް | ތ ައ ލ ް | ތ ައ ލ ް | ތ ައ ލ ް |
| u | ee | i | aa | a |
| ތ ައ ލ ް | ތ ައ ލ ް | ތ ައ ލ ް | ތ ައ ލ ް | ތ ައ ލ ް |
| oa | o | ey | e | oo |

*ައ* = *a*, *ައ* = *aa*. With sukun (*ައ*) it doubles the next letter.



**ތ IS FOR**

# ތ ަ ނ ް ބ ު

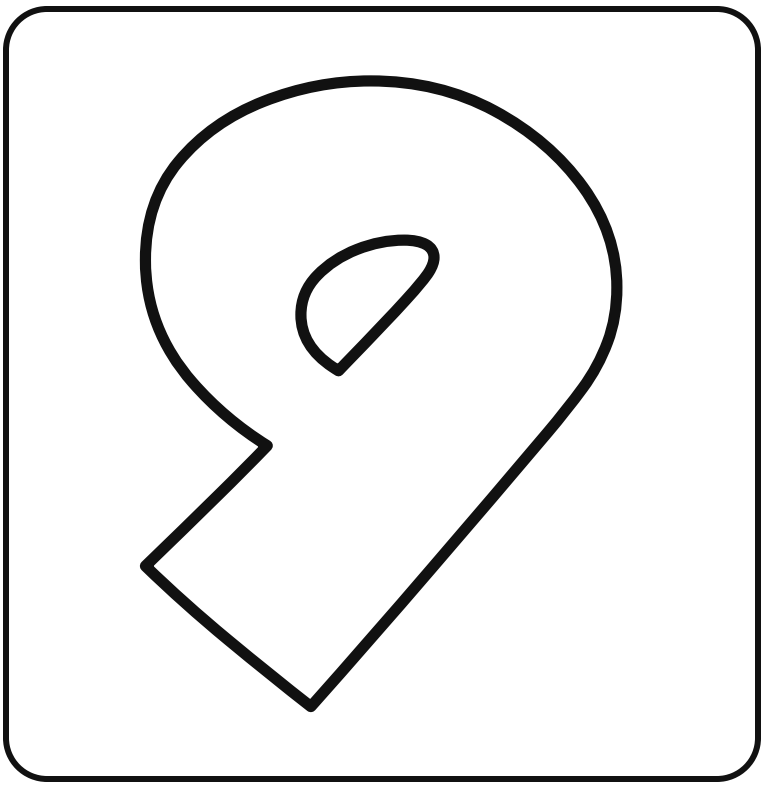
*anbu*

**mango**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ލިޔުއްވާ**

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**NAME · ނަންގ**

ވ ◌ް ◌ާ ◌ު

*vaavu*

**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

between ‘v’ and ‘w’

**LETTER + FILI (VOWEL SIGNS)**

| | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| ◌ް | ◌ާ | ◌ި | ◌ު | ◌ަ |
| vu | vee | vi | vaa | va |
| ◌ް | ◌ާ | ◌ި | ◌ު | ◌ަ |
| voa | vo | vey | ve | voo |



**ވ IS FOR**

ވ◌ާ ◌ި

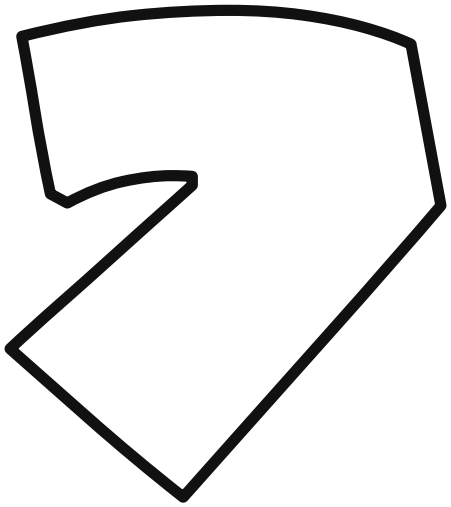
*vaarey*

**rain**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ލިޔުއްވާ**

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**NAME · ނަންމަ**

ﻣ

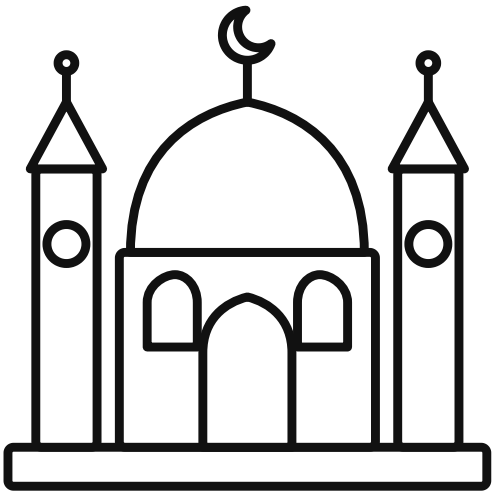
*meemu*

**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

‘m’ as in “moon”

**LETTER + FILI (VOWEL SIGNS)**

| | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| ﻣُ | ﻣِ | ﻣَ | ﻣَا | ﻣ |
| mu | mee | mi | maa | ma |
| ﻣ | ﻣ | ﻣ | ﻣ | ﻣ |
| moa | mo | mey | me | moo |



**ﷺ IS FOR**

ﻣ ﺳ ﮐ ﻳ

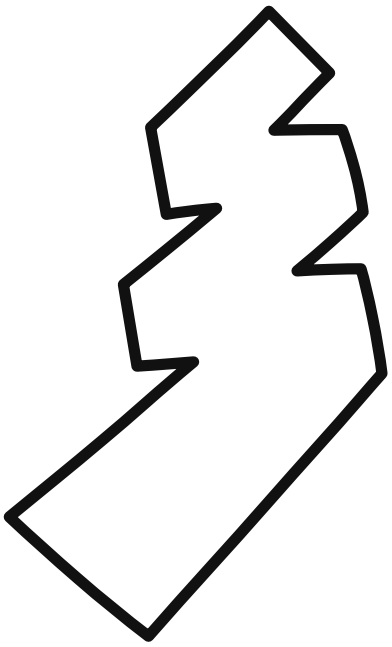
*miskiy*

**mosque**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ؤ ،ﺗ ،ﺮ ،ﻮ**

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**NAME · ނަންފަ**

ފ

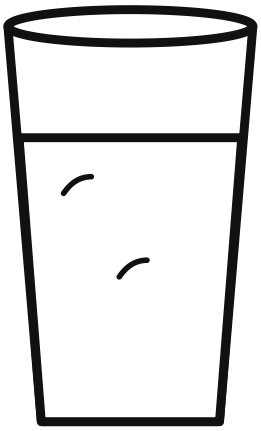
*faafu*

**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

‘f’ as in “fan”

**LETTER + FILI (VOWEL SIGNS)**

| | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| ފ ު | ފ ޫ | ފ ި | ފ ާ | ފ ަ |
| fu | fee | fi | faa | fa |
| ފ ޮ | ފ ޯ | ފ ެ | ފ ේ | ފ ෝ |
| foa | fo | fey | fe | foo |



**ފ IS FOR**

ފޮށި

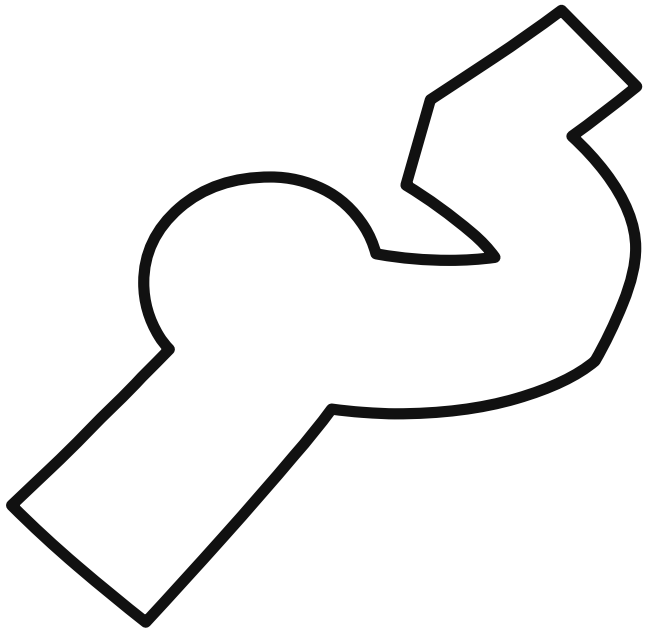
*fen*

**water**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ފާތިހާ**

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NAME · ނަންގ

# ދ

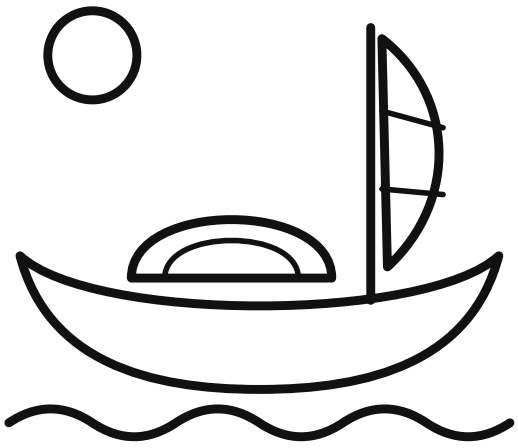
*dhaalu*

**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

a soft ‘d’ — tongue touches the back of the teeth (written ‘dh’)

**LETTER + FILI (VOWEL SIGNS)**

| | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| ދު dhu | ދޫ dhee | ދި dhi | ދާ dhaa | ދަ dha |
| ދޮ dhoa | ދޯ dho | ދޭ dhey | ދެ dhe | ދޫ dhoo |



**ދ IS FOR**

# ދޯނި

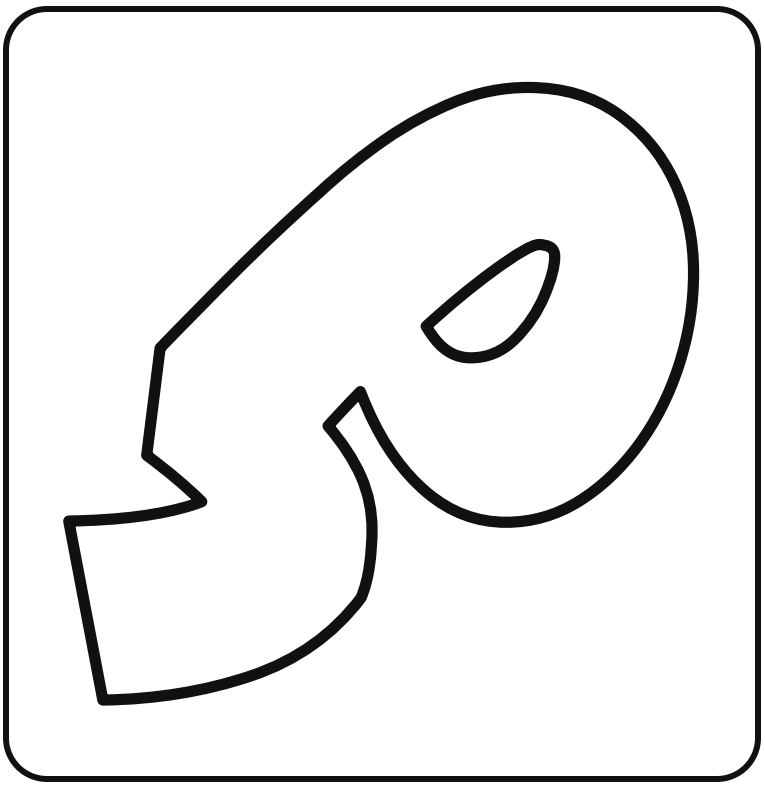
*dhoani*

**dhoni, a Maldivian boat**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ؤ ދ ؤ**

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**NAME · ނަން**

# ތ

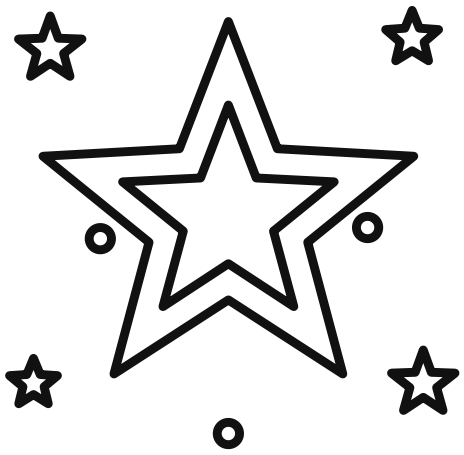
*thaa*

**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

a soft ‘t’ — tongue touches the back of the teeth (written ‘th’, not English “th”)

**LETTER + FILI (VOWEL SIGNS)**

| | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| ތު | ތޫ | ތި | ތާ | ތަ |
| thu | thee | thi | thaa | tha |
| ތ ް | ތ ް | ތ ް | ތ ް | ތ ް |
| thoa | tho | they | the | thoo |



**ތ IS FOR**

# ތާރި

*thari*

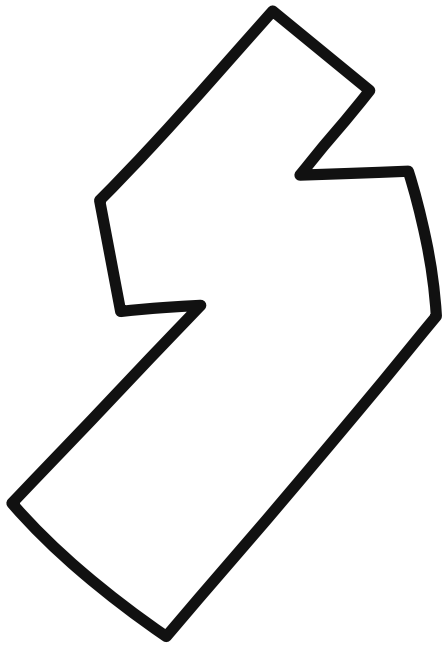
**star**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ލިޔުއްވާ**

ތ ތ ތ ތ

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**NAME · ނަންމަ**

ލާ

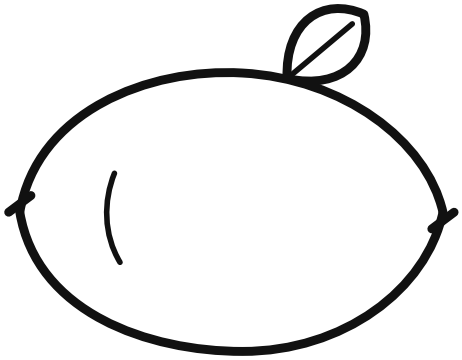
*laamu*

**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

'l' as in "lamp"

**LETTER + FILI (VOWEL SIGNS)**

| | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| ލ ު | ލ ූ | ލ ි | ලා | ල |
| lu | lee | li | laa | la |
| ලෝ | ලෙ | ලේ | ලෛ | ලෞ |
| loa | lo | ley | le | loo |



**ލ IS FOR**

# ލުންބޮ

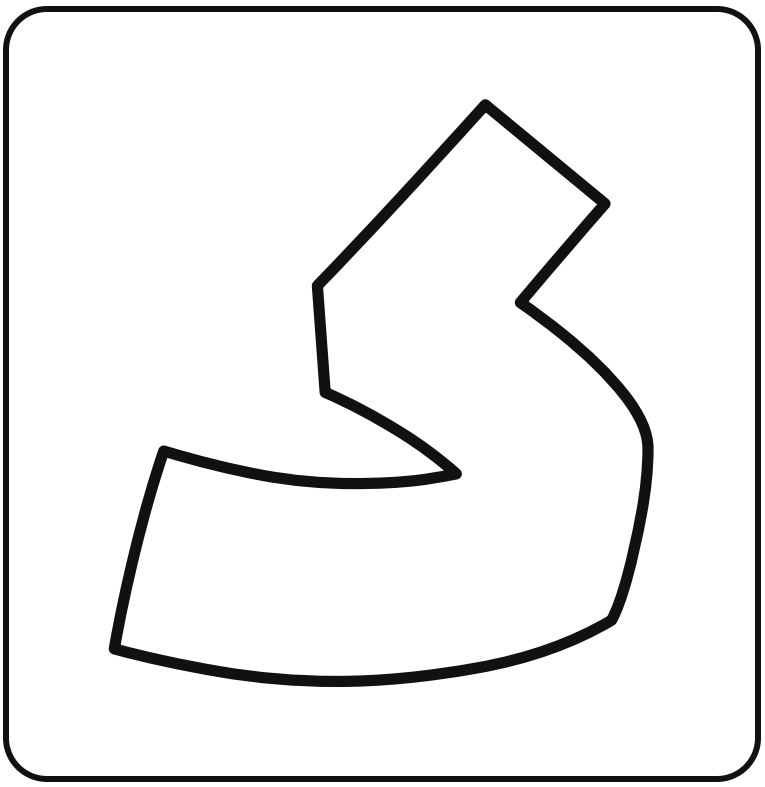
*lunboa*

**lime**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ލިއްޓާ**

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**NAME · ނަން**

# ގާފު

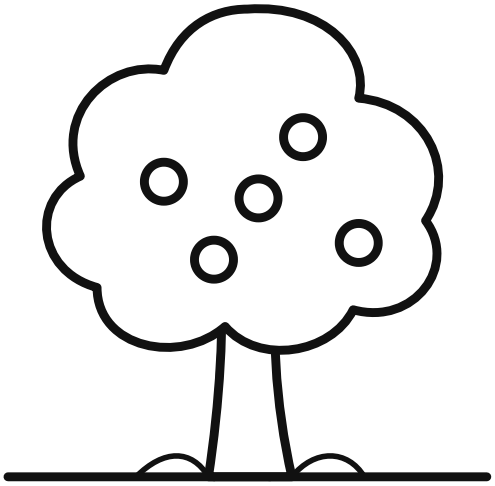
*gaafu*

**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

‘g’ as in “go”

**LETTER + FILI (VOWEL SIGNS)**

| | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| ގ ُ | ގ ٍ | ގ ִ | ގ ָ | ގ َ |
| gu | gee | gi | gaa | ga |
| ގ ٗ | ގ ٚ | ގ ٜ | ގ ٖ | ގ ٙ |
| goa | go | gey | ge | goo |



**ގ IS FOR**

# ގަހު

*gas*

**tree**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ލިޔުއްވާ**

ގ ގ ގ ގ

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# ށ

**NAME · ނަން**

## ށ ގ ވ ި ޔ ަ ނ ީ

*gnaviyani*

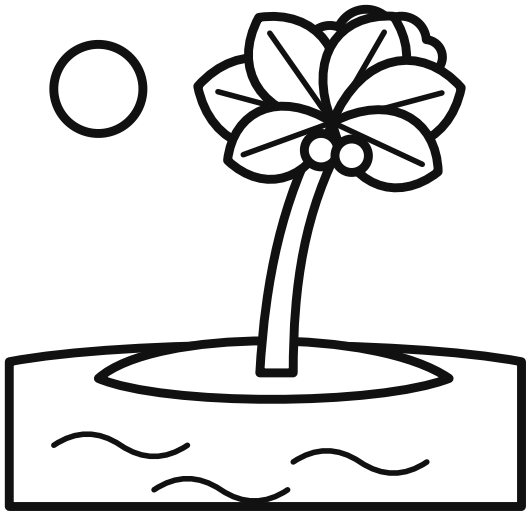
**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

'ny' as in "canyon" — a rare old letter

**LETTER + FILI (VOWEL SIGNS)**

| | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| ށ ު | ށ ެ | ށ ި | ށ ާ | ށ |
| gnu | gnee | gni | gnaa | gna |
| ށ ް | ށ ް ޚ | ށ ް ؘ | ށ ް ؚ | ށ ް ؙ |
| gnoa | gno | gney | gne | gnoo |

ށ is hardly used in words today, but a whole atoll, the island of Fuvahmulah, carries its name!



**ށ IS FOR**

## ށ ގ ވ ި ޔ ަ ނ ީ ތ ޮ ޅ ު

*gnaviyani atholhu*

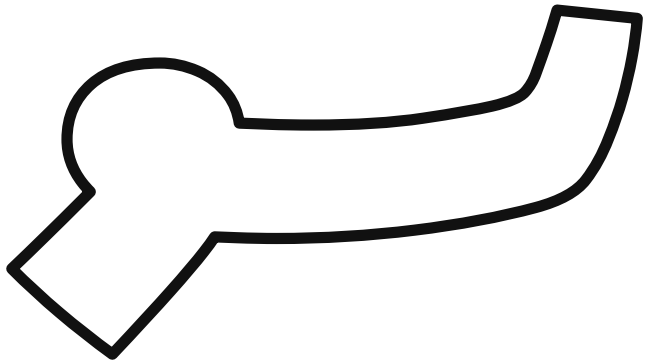
**Gnaviyani Atoll (Fuvahmulah island)**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ލިޔުއްވާ**

ށ ށ ށ ށ

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**NAME · ނަންނު**

# ސީނު

*seenu*

**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

‘s’ as in “sun”

**LETTER + FILI (VOWEL SIGNS)**

| | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| ސު | ސީ | ސި | ސާ | ސަ |
| su | see | si | saa | sa |
| ސ ۊ | ސ ۏ | ސ ۑ | ސ ۓ | ސ ے |
| soa | so | sey | se | soo |



**ސ IS FOR**

# ސޭ

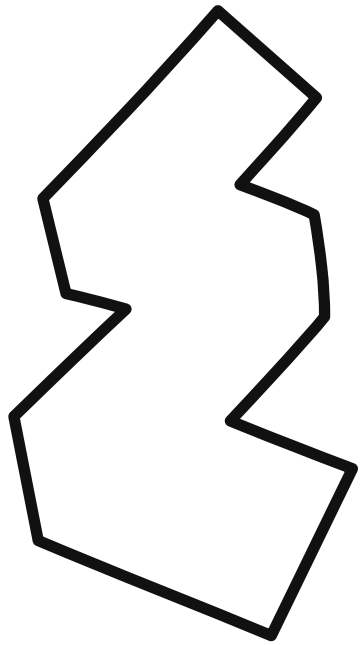
*sai*

**tea**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ؤ ތްރޭ**

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NAME · ނަން

ދ ވ ިޔ ަ ނ ި

*daviyani*

**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

a hard ‘d’ — curl your tongue back (written ‘d’)

**LETTER + FILI (VOWEL SIGNS)**

| | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| ދ ް | ދ ީ | ދ ި | ދ ާ | ދ |
| du | dee | di | daa | da |
| ދ ޮ | ދ ެ | ދ ේ | ދ ේ | ދ ෝ |
| doa | do | dey | de | doo |

Find ދ inside ނ ަ ސ ް ރ ެ އ ް — it hardly ever starts a word.



ދ IS FOR

ނ ަ ސ ް ރ ެ އ ް

*handoo*

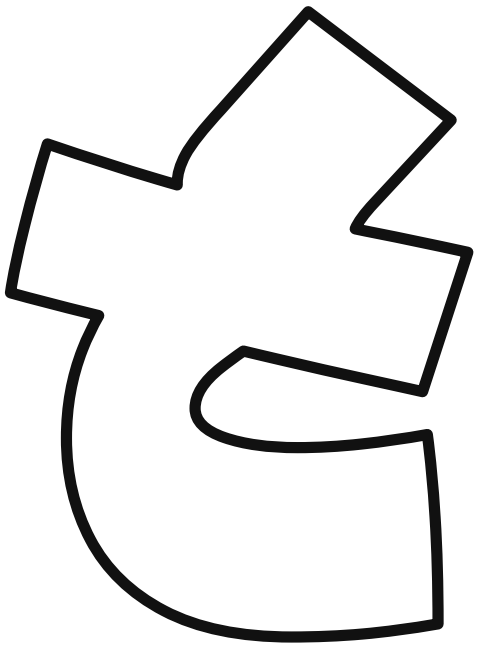
**rice (grains)**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ލ ިޔ ެ ފ ި

ދ ދ ދ ދ

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NAME · ނަން

ޒަވިޔަނި

*zaviyani*

**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

'z' as in "zoo" — mostly in words from Arabic

**LETTER + FILI (VOWEL SIGNS)**

| | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| ޒ ُ | ޒ ٖ | ޒ ِ | ޒ ٓ | ޒ َ |
| zu | zee | zi | zaa | za |
| ޒ ۥ | ޒ ٗ | ޒ ٔ | ޒ ٕ | ޒ ٙ |
| zoa | zo | zey | ze | zoo |



**ޒ IS FOR**

ޒަމްޒަމް

*zamzam*

## Zamzam water from Makkah

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ލިޔުއްވާ**

ޒ ޒ ޒ ޒ

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ﷺ

**NAME · ނަން**

**ތ ާ ވ ި ޔ ަ ނ ި**

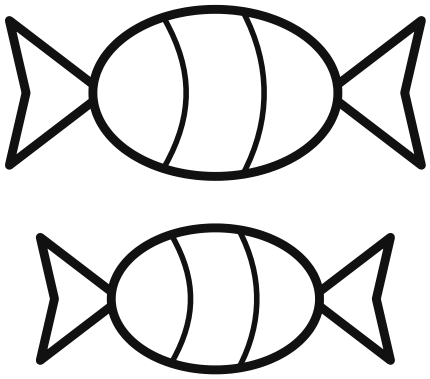
*taviyani*

**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

a hard ‘t’ — curl your tongue back (written ‘t’)

**LETTER + FILI (VOWEL SIGNS)**

| | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| ތ ު | ތ ޫ | ތ ި | ތ ާ | ތ ަ |
| tu | tee | ti | taa | ta |
| ތ ޮ | ތ ޯ | ތ ެ | ތ ේ | ތ ෝ |
| toa | to | tey | te | too |



**ތ IS FOR**

**ތ ޮ ފ ީ**

*tofee*

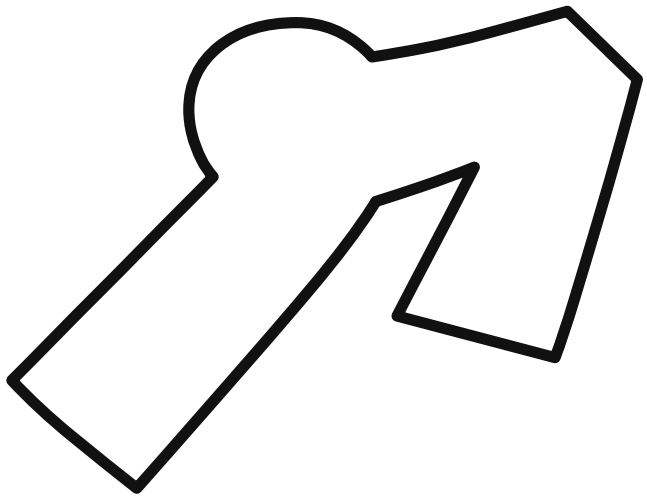
**toffee, a sweet**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ލިޔުއްވާ**

ﷺ ﷺ ﷺ ﷺ

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**NAME · ނަން**

ﯼ

*yaa*

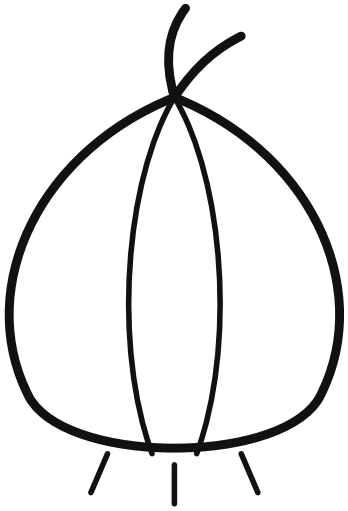
**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

‘y’ as in “yes”

**LETTER + FILI (VOWEL SIGNS)**

| | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| ﯼ ُ | ﯼ ِ | ﯼ ِ | ﯼ ّ | ﯼ َ |
| yu | yee | yi | yaa | ya |
| ﯼ ٗ | ﯼ ٖ | ﯼ ٘ | ﯼ ٙ | ﯼ ٚ |
| yoa | yo | yey | ye | yoo |

Find ﯼ inside ﻓِﯼ — it hardly ever starts a word.



**ﯼ IS FOR**

ﻓِﯼ

*fiyaa*

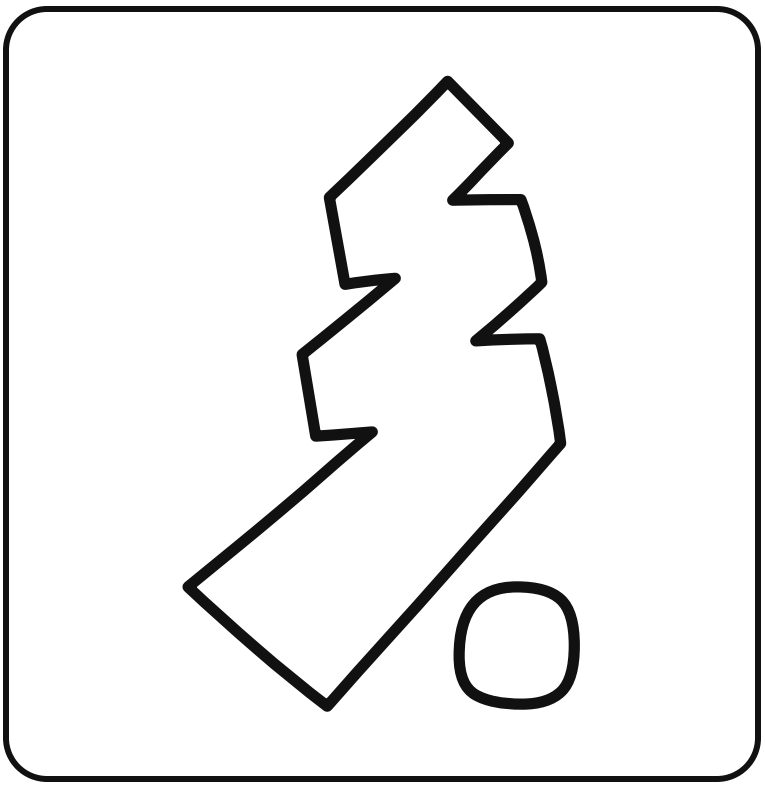
**onion**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ﻓِﯼ**

ﯼ ﯼ ﯼ ﯼ

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NAME · ނަން

# ޕަވިޔަނި

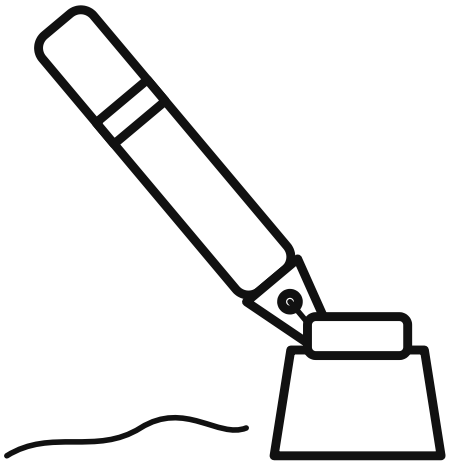
*paviyani*

**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

‘p’ as in “pen” — mostly in words from English

**LETTER + FILI (VOWEL SIGNS)**

| | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| ޕُ | ޕُ | ޕِ | ޕָ | ޕַ |
| pu | pee | pi | paa | pa |
| ޕ | ޕ | ޕ | ޕ | ޕ |
| poa | po | pey | pe | poo |



**ޕ IS FOR**

# ޕެން

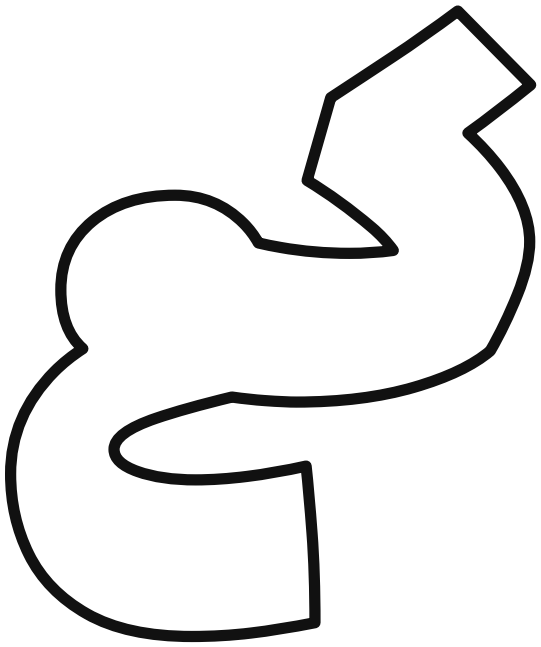
*pen*

**pen**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ލިޔުއްވާ**

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NAME · ނަން

ޖަވިޔަނި

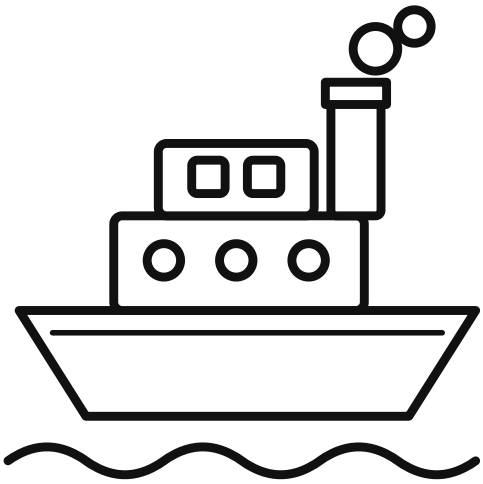
*javiyani*

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘j’ as in “jam”

LETTER + FILI (VOWEL SIGNS)

| ja | jaa | ji | jee | ju |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| ޖަ | ޖާ | ޖި | ޖީ | ޖު |
| **joo** | **je** | **jey** | **jo** | **joa** |
| ޜޫ | ޜެ | ޜޭ | ޜོ | ޜོ |



ޖ IS FOR

ޖަޒާއު

*jahaazu*

**ship**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ލިޔުއްވާ

ޖ ޖ ޖ ޖ

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ﭺ

NAME · ނަން

ﭼ ﮪ ﮨ ﮩ ﮯ

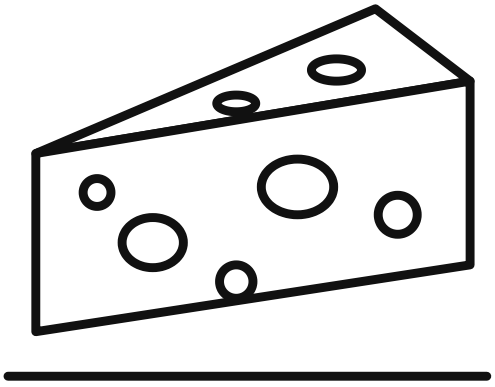
*chaviyani*

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘ch’ as in “chair”

LETTER + FILI (VOWEL SIGNS)

| | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| ﭺ ﮫ | ﭺ ﮬ | ﭺ ﮭ | ﭺ ﮮ | ﭺ ﮯ |
| chu | chee | chi | chaa | cha |
| ﭺ ﮰ | ﭺ ﮱ | ﭺ ﮲ | ﭺ ﮳ | ﭺ ﮴ |
| choa | cho | chey | che | choo |



ﭺ IS FOR

ﭺ ﮭ ﮩ ﮯ

*cheez*

**cheese**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ލިޔާ

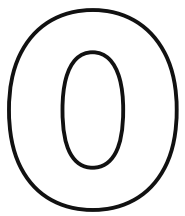
ﭺ ﭺ ﭺ ﭺ

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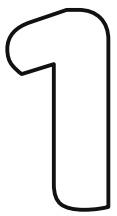
BONUS

# Dhivehi numbers ތަކުތު *(adhadhu)*

Color the numbers and count out loud in Dhivehi: *sumeh*, *ekeh*, *dhey*, *thineh*...



0
ސުމެއް
*sumeh*
zero



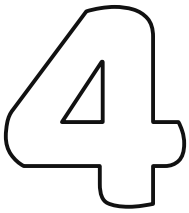
1
ހަބަ
*ekeh*
one



2
ދެ
*dhey*
two



3
ތިނެ
*thineh*
three



4
ހަތަރެ
*hathareh*
four



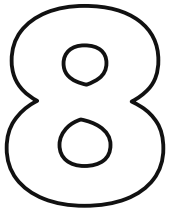
5
ފަހެ
*faheh*
five



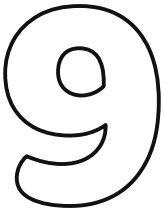
6
ހަހ
*haeh*
six



7
ހަތެ
*hatheh*
seven



8
ހަށެ
*asheh*
eight



9
ނުވަ
*nuvaeh*
nine

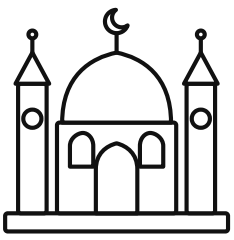
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LET'S TALK

# My first Dhivehi words ފުރަތަމަ ބަސްތަކެއް

Now that you know the letters, try saying these with your family.

| | |
|---|---|
| ﷺ | *assalaamu alaikum*<br>**Peace be upon you (the Muslim greeting)** |
| وَعَلَيْكُمُ السَّلَامُ | *va alaikum assalaam*<br>**And upon you be peace (the reply)** |
| ... ގަނޑުގެ ނަމަކީ | *aharenge namakee ...*<br>**My name is ...** |
| شُكْرِيًّا | *shukuriyyaa*<br>**Thank you** |
| جَزَاكَ اللهُ خَيْرًا | *jazaakallaahu khairan*<br>**May Allah reward you with good** |
| ދާދި · ބައްޕަ | *manma · bappa*<br>**Mother · Father** |
| ބޭބެ · ދަތްތަ | *beybe · dhaththa*<br>**Big brother · Big sister** |
| ހާ · ނޫން | *aan · noon*<br>**Yes · No** |
| ގަނޑުގެ ދިވެހި ބަސް ދަސްކުރަމުން ދަނީ! | *aharen dhivehi bas dhaskuramun dhanee!*<br>**I am learning Dhivehi!** |







REFERENCES & SOURCES

# Where our facts come from

[1] **The Noble Qur'an** — Surah Ar-Raḥmān 55:1–4, Surah Ar-Rūm 30:22 and Surah Al-Ḥujurāt 49:13. Arabic text and meanings checked against **Quran.com**; the English meanings in this book are simplified for children.

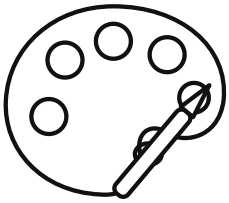
[2] **Map** — outlines from **Natural Earth** (public domain), via the *world-atlas* data set.

[3] **Language facts** — speaker numbers from **Ethnologue** (SIL International); the history of the Thaana letters from standard reference works on the script.

**What's next?**
You have met all **24 Dhivehi letters**! Keep practising by reading signs, books and food packets written in Dhivehi, and look out for the other books in the **Allamahul Bayan Series**, in shā' Allāh.

**Enjoyed this book?**
A short review on Amazon helps other families find it — *jazākumullāhu khayran!*







# Certificate of Achievement

## ދެށްوالله! ވަތަކުރ ތަނަވަސް!

*maashaallaah! varah rangalhu! — Well done, very good!*

This certifies that

_____

has learned, traced and colored
**all 24 letters of the Dhivehi alphabet**.

Date _____ Grown-up's signature _____

*Minhaz Reza*

Hafez Abdullah Muhammad Minhaz Reza, author

**Maktabatu Kunujul Akhirah** — Publisher
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